

Hongwei (Henry) Zhou

hzhou55@ucsc.edu | normand-1024.github.io

EDUCATION

2019-2025 **University of California, Santa Cruz**

PH.D. AND M.S. IN COMPUTATIONAL MEDIA

- **M.S. Thesis:** Islands and Bridges of Language: Bio-Inspired Structural Analysis of Language Embedding Data
- **Ph.D. Expected Defense Date:** June 2025

2015-2019 **New York University, Tandon School of Engineering**

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE, MINOR IN GAME ENGINEERING

PUBLICATIONS

JOURNAL ARTICLES

- [J2] **Zhou, H.**, Meng, F., Kosolapova, K., & Wardrip-Fruin, N. (2024). More than Interactivity: Designing a Critical AI Game beyond Ludo-Centrism. *Humanities*. [Submitted]
- [J1] **Zhou, H.** (2024). Infrastructure of Agency: An Anti-essentialist and Post-humanist Framework for Video Game Agency. *Journal of Games Criticism*, 6(A), 1-22.

CONFERENCE PAPERS

- [C5] **Zhou, H.**, Wardrip-Fruin, N., & Mateas, M. (2024). Corporeal Capture: The Rhetoric of Boundaries in Procedurality. In Proceedings of DiGRA 2024 Conference: Playgrounds.
- [C4] **Zhou, H.**, Zhu, J., Mateas, M., & Wardrip-Fruin, N. (2024, May). The Eyes, the Hands and the Brain: What can Text-to-Image Models Offer for Game Design and Visual Creativity?. In Proceedings of the 19th International Conference on the Foundations of Digital Games (pp. 1-13).
- [C3] **Zhou, H.**, Gonzalez, K., Altice, N., Wardrip-Fruin, N., & Forbes, A. G. (2022, January). On the Maintenance of Meaning: A Deleuzian View on Proceduralism. In Proceedings of DiGRA 2022 Conference: Bringing Worlds Together.
- [C2] **Zhou, H.**, Gong, Y., Mugrai, L., Khalifa, A., Nealen, A., & Togelius, J. (2018, August). A hybrid search agent in pommerman. In Proceedings of the 13th international conference on the foundations of digital games (pp. 1-4).
- [C1] Gopstein, D., **Zhou, H. H.**, Frankl, P., & Cappos, J. (2018, May). Prevalence of confusing code in software projects: Atoms of confusion in the wild. In Proceedings of the 15th international conference on mining software repositories (pp. 281-291).

WORKSHOP PAPERS

- [W2] **Zhou, H.**, & Forbes, A. G. (2022, October). Data Feel: Exploring Visual Effects in Video Games to Support Sense-making Tasks. In 2022 IEEE 7th Workshop on Visualization for the Digital Humanities (VIS4DH) (pp. 6-12). IEEE.
- [W1] **Zhou, H. H.**, Elek, O., Anand, P., & Forbes, A. G. (2020, October). Bio-inspired structure identification in language embeddings. In 2020 IEEE 5th Workshop on Visualization for the Digital Humanities (VIS4DH) (pp. 7-13). IEEE.

FUNDRAISING

ONGOING

2024-2025 **Coha-Gunderson Prize in Speculative Futures**, The Humanities Institute

\$ 2,000

PRESENTATIONS/TALKS

CONFERENCE

- 2023 **Zhou, H.** Reframing Posthuman Agency through the Concept of Speed. Oral presentation: DiGRA 2023 Conference, Sevilla, Spain.

TEACHING

TEACHING ASSISTANT

- Su2024 **CMPM 80K**, Foundations of Video Game Design
Sp2024 **CMPM 80I**, Introduction to Human Computer Interaction
W2024 **CMPM 80J**, Games as Technical Culture
F2023 **CMPM 25**, Introduction to 3D Modeling
Su2023 **CMPM 80K**, Foundations of Video Game Design
Sp2023 **CMPM 151**, Algorithmic Music for Games
W2023 **CMPM 176**, Game Systems
F2022 **CMPM 25**, Introduction to 3D Modeling
Sp2022 **CMPM 80K**, Foundations of Video Game Design
W2022 **CMPM 176**, Game Systems
F2021 **CMPM 25**, Introduction to 3D Modeling
Sp2021 **CMPM 172**, Game Design Studio III
W2021 **CMPM 171**, Game Design Studio II
F2020 **CMPM 170**, Game Design Studio I
Su2020 **CMPM 146**, Game AI
W2020 **CMPM 35**, Data Structures for Interactive Media
F2019 **CMPM 179/ARTG 179**, Game Design Practicum

MENTORING

- Su2023 **UCSC Science Internship Program (High School Students)**, AI Art Literature Survey with Lynn Dai, Adanur Durunas, Venkat Ramisetty, preliminary work for [C4]

SERVICE

REVIEWING AND PROGRAM COMMITTEE

- Conference **International Conference on Interactive Digital Storytelling (ICIDS)**, 2023-Present

DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE

- 2023-2024 **Community Manager**, UCSC Computational Media Department
2020-2023 **Community Management Assistant**, UCSC Computational Media Department

REFERENCES

Michael Mateas (Advisor)
mmateas@ucsc.edu
Professor, Computational Media
University of California, Santa Cruz

Noah Wardrip-Fruin (Advisor)
nwardrip@ucsc.edu
Professor, Computational Media
University of California, Santa Cruz

Samantha Gorman (Teaching Reference)
sagorman@ucsc.edu
Professor, Computational Media
University of California, Santa Cruz

Jichen Zhu (Dissertation Committee)
jicz@itu.dk
Professor, Digital Design
IT University of Copenhagen